

SAMAR BAGCHI | 76 FORMER DIRECTOR,
Birla Industrial and Technological Museum, Kolkata

ROTE NOT TAKEN

Committing to memory and vomiting on paper. This is how Samar Bagchi sums up his take on science education in Indian schools. He's been trying to undo the damage inflicted on generations of students from his days at the Birla Industrial and Technological Museum in Kolkata, where as director he carried out wide-ranging education programmes in schools in West Bengal. Whether it was through the popular science quiz, *Quest*, on Doordarshan, between 1983 and 1988, or the 100-odd workshops that he conducted in schools for science teachers, with the slogans, 'Science is Doing' and 'Where There is no Laboratory', Bagchi has always been a people's scientist. He received a national award in 1992 for popularising science through the media.

by Abhijit Dasgupta

"Bagchi's work is a novelty. It saves time and is cost-effective." K.A. Sadat, Principal,
District Institute of Education Training, Hooghly

Education B.Sc from Calcutta University, mining engineering from ISM, Dhanbad.

Usually to be found Working with teachers and students.

Loves Classical music, reading poetry and travelling to the mountains.

Hates Education being reduced to rote learning without understanding of basic principles.



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